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Cities Are Covering Flock Cameras With Trash Bags



JASON KOEBLER • MAY 28, 2026 AT 12:18 PM

Regretful cities aren't sure how to cancel their surveillance contracts, so they are literally covering their cameras.



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The city of Dayton, Ohio has covered its Flock automated license plate reader cameras with black trash bags in part because police there are unsure whether the cameras are still active and the city also doesn't seem to know whether it is allowed to take the cameras down. The move comes after months of resident outrage, a scandal in which the city was sharing Flock camera data for immigration enforcement apparently on accident, and a \$30,000 audit into how the cameras are being used.

Joe Parlette, the deputy city manager of Dayton, said at a city commission meeting last week that the "Dayton Police Department agreed to work with Public Works to put bags over the cameras" as a stop-gap measure until Flock cameras could be removed entirely. I spoke to multiple people in Dayton who said they had seen bagged cameras in the last few days. The [Dayton Daily News](#) first reported on the baggings.

BAGGED FLOCK CAMERAS IN DAYTON. IMAGE: MELISSA BERTOLO

Dayton is not the first city to cover its Flock cameras with trash bags because

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last year, the city of Evanston, Illinois also covered its cameras with trash bags

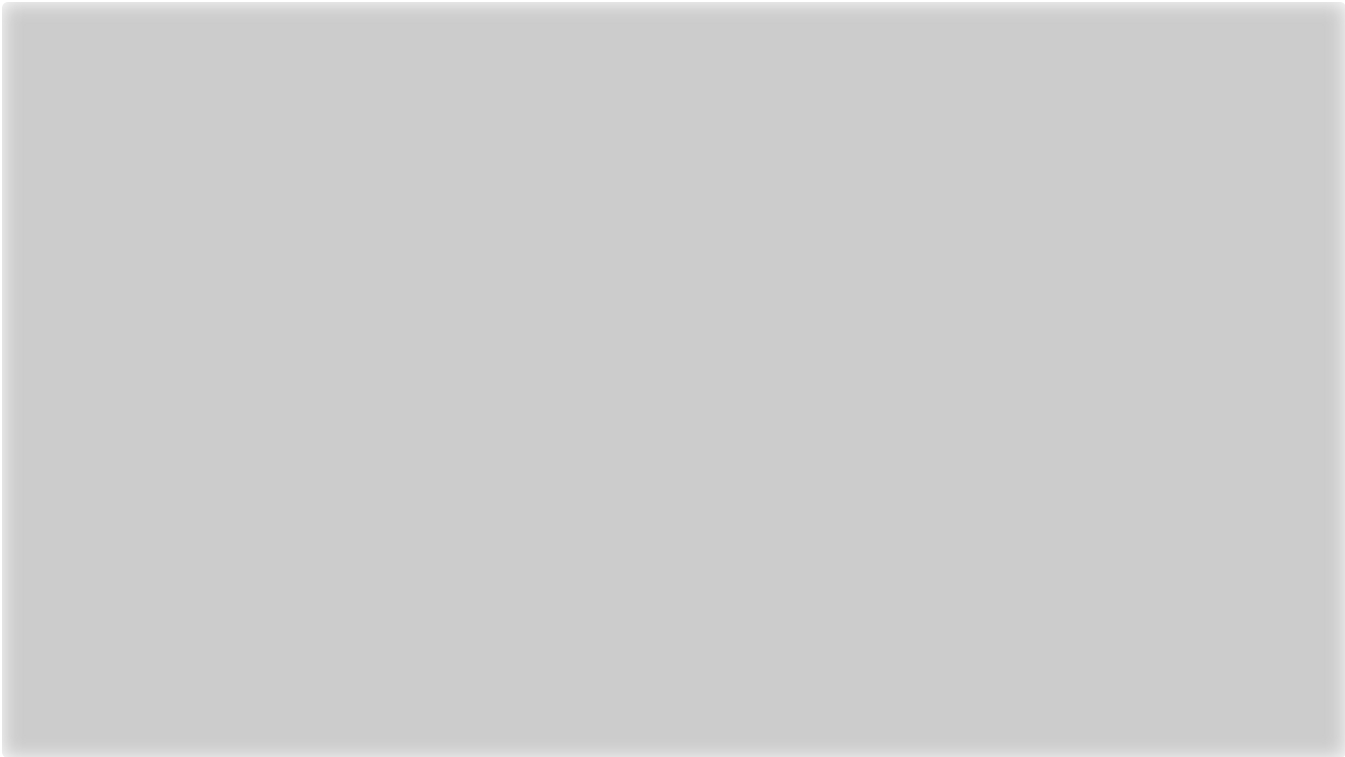
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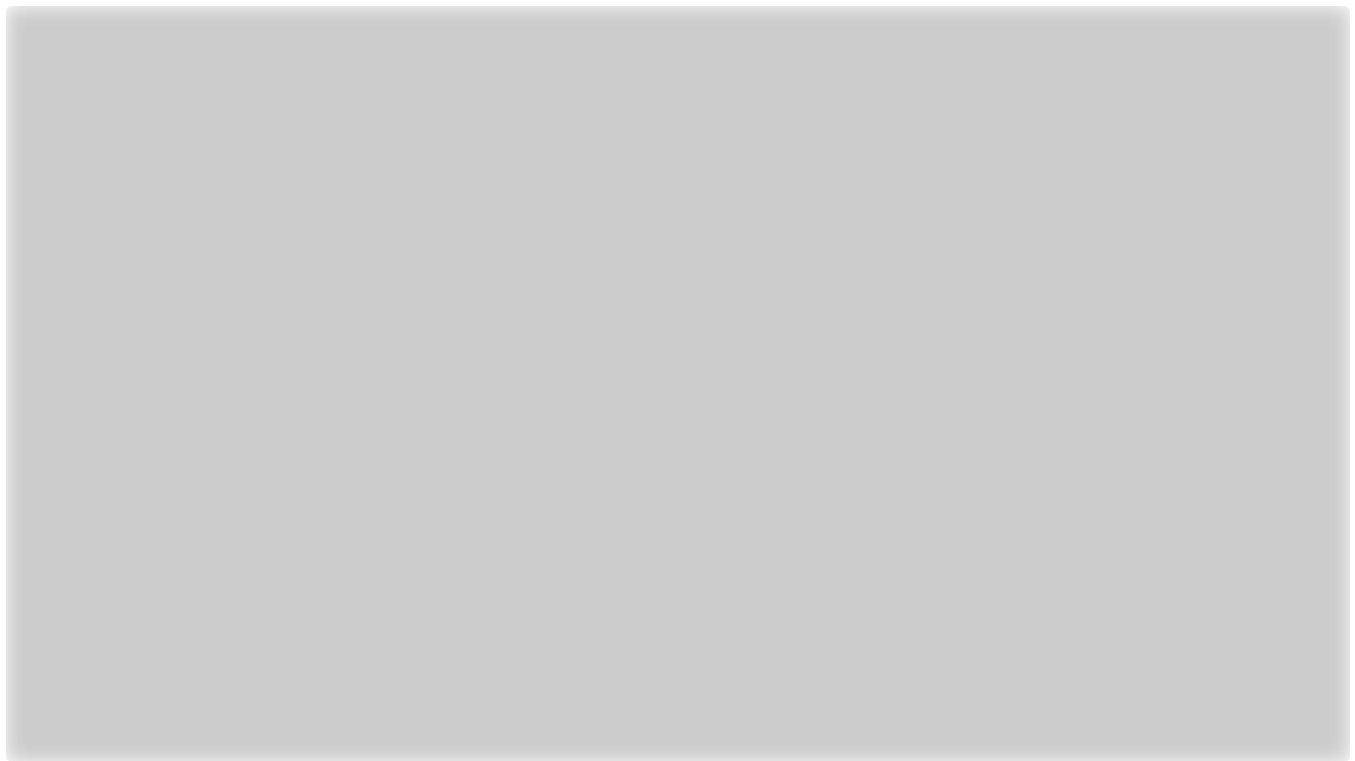


After Town Bans Flock, Councilmember Crashes Out, Proposes Internet and Phone Ban

A Texas councilmember will propose "a total ban on all cellular and GPS-capable devices for all operations within city limits" and "a total termination of all internet services."



JASON KOEBLER · MAY 20, 2026



City Learns Flock Accessed Cameras in Children's Gymnastics Room as a Sales Pitch Demo, Renews Contract Anyway

Residents of Dunwoody, Georgia are furious about the city's surveillance contract with Flock. Do their elected officials care?



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